

**THE LUNG SYSTEM
IN TRADITIONAL CHINESE MEDICINE**
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The lung, situated in the thorax, communicates with the throat and opens into the nose. It occupies the uppermost position among the zang-fu organs, and is known as the "canopy" of the zang-fu organs. Because the lung is a delicate organ it can be easily attacked by external pathogens and also cannot tolerate cold and heat. Traditional Chinese medicine holds that the lung is a "fragile" organ. The lung is vigor's house and qi's master. It belongs to metal in the five elements theory. The physiological functions of the lung are dominating qi to control respiration, dominating dispersing to rule the skin and body hair, and dominating descending to regulate the water passages. Other characteristics of the lung are to open into the nose and to manifest in the body hair. The lung is also related to the emotional state of sadness, and nasal mucus in the body fluid. The meridian of the lung leads to the large intestine, and the lung is thus externally and internally related to the large intestine.

The Pattern Identification and Therapeutics of the Lung Disorders

The lung disorders generally manifest as deficient and excessive types. The deficient types often present as the deficiency of qi and insufficiency of yin and body fluid. The excessive types could be caused by pathogenic wind cold, wind heat and wind dryness, or phlegm attacking the lung. The common symptoms and signs of lung disorders may be seen as cough, asthma, chest pain, hemoptysis and the others.

1. Deficiency of lung qi

This is the manifestation of hypofunction lung qi. It may be due to chronic cough or asthma which damages the lung qi, or to insufficiency of the qi production.

Clinical Manifestation:

feeble cough or asthma
shortness breath which is worse on exertion
soft and weak voice
fatigue
spontaneous sweating
aversion to cold
pale face
pale tongue with thin, white coating
weak pulse

Prognosis & Complications:

The Lung Qi Xu:
Wind Cold or wind Heat (Wei Qi Xu)
The Lung & Heart Qi Xu
The Lung & Spleen Qi Xu

The Lung & Kidney Qi Xu

Differentiation:

The Spleen Qi Xu

The Heart Qi Xu

The Kidney Qi Xu

Therapeutics:

Reinforcing the lung qi.

Acupuncture:

Feishu	UB 13
Zhongfu	Lu 1
Gaohuang	UB 43
Taiyuan	Lu 9
Zhusanli	St 36

Herbal Formulation:

Reinforcing the lung qi formula

Liu Jun Zi Tang

Ren Shen (Ginseng)	9 g
Gan Cao (Baked licorice)	6 g
Bai Zhu (White atractylodes)	9 g
Fu Ling (Poria)	12 g
Chen Pi (Citrus peel)	6 g
Ban Xia (Pinellia)	9 g

2. Deficiency of the lung yin

This is the manifestation of the lung yin failing to nourish the lung which produces deficient fire on the interior. It often results from a prolonged cough which injures the lung yin. Pathogenic factors attack the lung and heat type diseases consume the body fluid which infect the lung yin.

Clinical Manifestation:

dry cough
or with a small amount of sticky sputum
or cough with blood tinged sputum
dry mouth and throat
afternoon fever
malar flush
night sweating
heat sensation in the five centers
dry red tongue
rapid and thready pulse

Prognosis & complications:

The Lung Yin Xu :

The Lung Qi & Yin Xu

The Lung & Stomach Yin Xu (Son & Mother relationship)

The Lung and Kidney Yin Xu (Mother & Son relationship)

Differentiation:

The Lung Yin xu

The Lung Heat

The Lung Dryness

Therapeutics:

Nourishing the lung yin

Acupuncture:

taiyuan	Lu 9
Feishu	UB 13
Gaohuang	UB 43
Sanyinjiao	Sp 6
Taixi	K 3
Yuji	Lu 10
Kongzhui	Lu 6

Herbal Formulation:

Nourishing the lung yin formula

Bai He Gu Jin Tang

Bai He (lily Bulb)	9 g
Sheng Di Huang (raw rehmannia)	30 g
Mai Men Dong (Ophiopogon)	9 g
Bai Shao (White peony)	9 g
Xuan Shen (Scrophularia)	9 g
Chuan Bei Mu (Tendrilled fritillary)	9 g
Dang Gui (Angelica)	9 g
Jie Geng (Platycodon)	6 g
Gan Cao (Licorice)	6 g
Xian He Cao (Agrimony herb)	30 g

3. Invasion of the lung by pathogenic cold

It may be caused by pathogenic cold invading the body and accumulateing in the lung. If complicated with exterior syndrome, it is known as wind cold type of external syndrome. If there are no exterior symptoms and signs, it is diagnosed as invasion of the lung by pathogenic cold.

Clinical manifestation:

cough

asthma

thin and white sputum
absence of thirst
runny nose with clear mucus
or complicated with
aversion to cold
fever
headache & body ache
white tongue
tight pulse

Prognosis & Complication:

The Lung cold :
Curable
Transforming to the lung heat
The lung damp phlegm
The lung qi xu

Differentiation:

The lung cold
Wind cold

Therapeutics:

Dispersing the lung and eliminating the cold

Acupuncture:

Lieque	Lu 7
Yingxiang	LI 20
Fengmen	UB 12
Fengchi	GB 20
Hegu	LI 4

Herbal Formulation:

Eliminating lung cold formula

Xiao Qing Long Tang

Ma Huang (Ephedra Sinica)
Xi Xin (Asarum sieboldii Miq.)
Gui Zhi (Ramulus Cinnamomi Cassiae)
Bai Shao (Radix Paeoniae Lactiflorae)
Gan Jiang (Rhizoma Zingiberis Officinalis)
Gan Cao (Radix Glycyrrhizae Uralensis)
Ban Xia (Rhizoma Pinelliae Ternatae Preparata)
Wu Wei Zi (Fructus Schisandrae Chinensis)

4. Invasion of the lung by pathogenic heat

It may be caused by pathogenic heat invading body and accumulating in the lung, or pathogenic cold accumulating in the lung and transforming into the heat. If complicated with exterior syndrome, it is known as wind heat type of external syndrome, but if there are no exterior symptoms and signs, it is diagnosed as invasion of the lung by pathogenic heat.

Clinical Manifestation:

cough
asthma
yellow sticky sputum
thirst
sore throat
fever
aversion to heat
chest pain
yellow purulent sputum with blood
constipation
concentrated urine

Prognosis & Complications:

The lung heat :
Curable
Body Fluid Deficiency
The heat defecting the pericardium
The lung yin xu

The differentiation:

The lung heat
The wind heat
The lung cold

Therapeutics:

Dispersing the lung and eliminating the heat

Acupuncture:

Chize	Lu 5
Yuji	Lu 10
Quchi	LI 11
Dazhui	Du 14
Waiguan	SJ 5

Herbal Formulation:

Eliminating the lung heat formula

Ma Xing Shi Gan Tang

Ma Huang (Ephedra)	9 g
Xing Ren (Apricot seed)	9 g

Shi Gao (Gypsum)	30 g
Gan Cao (Baked licorice)	6 g

5. Invasion of the lung by pathogenic dryness

It may be caused by pathogenic dryness invading the body and consuming the lung yin, or pathogenic wind heat damages the body fluid and transforms into the dryness. It is often seen in the Fall.

Clinical Manifestation:

dry cough with little sputum
sputum is too sticky to cough out
dry nose and throat
chest pain
dry tongue with thin coating
rapid and thready pulse

Prognosis and Complication:

Lung dryness:
Body fluid deficiency
Lung yin deficiency
Large intestine fluid deficiency

Differentiation:

The lung Dryness:
Body Fluid Deficiency
Lung Yin Xu
Lung Heat

Therapeutics:

Clearing the lung and moistening the dryness

Acupuncture:

Lieque	Lu 7
Taiyuan	Lu 9
Yuji	Lu 10
Hegu	LI 4
Sanyinjiao	Sp 6

Herbal Formulation:

Moistening the lung dryness formula

Qing Zao Jiu Fei Tang

Sang Ye (folium mori albae)
Shi Gao (gypsum)
Mai Men Dong (tuber ophiopogonis japonici)
E Jiao (gelatinum corii asini)

Hei Zhi Ma (semen sesami indici)
Xing Ren (semen pruni armeniacae)
Mi Zhi Pi Pa Ye (honey fried folium eriobotryae japonicae)
Ren Shen (radix ginseng)
Gan Cao (radix glycyrrhizae uralensis)

6. Retention of phlegm damp in the lung

This is due to frequent attacks of cough following the exposure to exogenous pathogenic wind, cold, heat and damp, or to prolonged cough and asthma disturbing the lung to distribute the fluid which accumulates to become sputum, or to dysfunction of the spleen in transportation leading to the formation of the phlegm damp.

Clinical manifestation:

cough with much frothy or white, sticky sputum
sputum is easy to cough out
stuffiness and fullness in the chest
asthma
gurgling with sputum in the chest
pale tongue with white sticky coating
wiry and slippery pulse

Prognosis & Complication:

Lung damp phlegm :
Acute lung Heat or cold Attack
Damp phlegm damage the spleen
Lung, spleen even kidney qi xu
Yin type edema

Differentiation:

The lung is just a container of phlegm
The spleen is the resource of the phlegm

Therapeutics:

Eliminating the damp and transforming the phlegm

Acupuncture:

Feishu	UB 13
Pishu	UB 20
Taiyuan	Lu 9
Taibai	Sp 3
Fenglong	St 40
Hegu	LI 4
Dingchuan	Extra

Herbal Formulation:

Transforming lung damp phlegm formula

Qing Fei Hua Tan Wan

Jiang ban xia (Rhizoma Pinelliae Ternatae)

Huang qin (Radix Scutellariae Baicalensis)

Fu ling (Sclerotium Poriae Cocos)

Zhi shi (Fructus Aurantii Immaturus)

Ku xing ren (Semen Pruni Armeniacae)

Gua lou (Fructus Trichosanthis)

Chen pi (Pericarpium Citri Reticulatae)

Dan nan xing (Arisaema Cum Bile)

7. The Effusion in the Chest and Costal Region

It can be associated with Pathogenic Beverage (Yin Syndrome) accumulating in the membrane that cover the lung and line the inside of the chest cavity. It may due to external pathogenic factors invades the lung directly; complicated from internal severe illness; and internal organ such as lung or spleen are impaired.

Clinical Manifestation:

A sharp chest pain

Pain worsens with breathing in or coughing

A sharp chest pain (pleuritic chest pain)

The pain may start and remain in one specific area of the chest wall, or

It may spread to the shoulder or back

To ease chest pain from pleurisy

a person with pleurisy often lies on the affected side

as a way of limiting movement of the chest wall.

In rare cases, the chest pain of pleurisy is a fairly constant, dull ache.

White or yellow sticky coating

Wiry and slippery pulse

Prognosis & Complication:

The Effusion in the Chest and costal Region:

Lung qi & yin xu

Heart & kidney yang xu

Sudden yang collapse

Differentiation:

The lung effusion

The lung phlegm

Therapeutics:

Warming the yang to dissolve beverage or effusion in the body

Acupuncture:

Zhusanli	St 36
Fenglong	St 40
Yinlingquan	Sp 9
Sanyinjiao	Sp 6
Shuifen	Ren 9

Herbal Formulation:

Ling Gui Zhu Gan Tang

Fu Ling (Poria)	12g
Gui Zhi (Cinnamon twig)	9g
Bai Zhu (White atractylodes)	9g
Gan Cao (licorice)	3g

8. Damp heat in the large intestine

This is often occurs in summer and autumn when pathogenic summer heat, damp and toxic heat invade the intestine and stomach. It may also be due to irregular food intake, excessive eating of raw and cold food, or intake of unclean food, all of which may injure the spleen, stomach and intestines.

Clinical Manifestation:

Abdominal pain
tenesmus
blood and mucus in the stools
diarrhea with yellow watery stools
a burning sensation of the anus
scanty deep yellow urine
possible fever
thirst
yellow sticky tongue coating
rolling and rapid pulse
or soft rapid pulse

Prognosis & Complication:

LI Damp Heat :
Body fluid xu
Acute qi collapse
Spleen qi xu

Differentiation:

LI damp heat
Spleen qi xu

Therapeutics:

Clearing damp heat in the intestine

Acupuncture:

Hegu	LI 4
Tianshu	St 25
Shangjuxu	St 37
Zhusanli	St 36

Herbal Formulation:

Eliminating the damp heat of intestine formula

Bai Tou Weng Tang

Bai Tou Weng (Pulsatilla)	15 g
Huang Lian (Coptis)	9 g
Huang Bai (Phellodendron)	12 g
Qin Pi (Fraxinus)	9 g

9. Consumption of the fluid of the large intestine

This often occurs in the elderly, in women after delivery, or in the late stage of a febrile disease when there is consumption of body fluid.

Clinical Manifestation:

dry stools
constipation
red tongue
yellow rough coating
thready pulse

Prognosis & Complications:

Consumption of the fluid of the large intestine :
Excessive heat of lung, heart, stomach and liver
Deficient heat of lung, heart, stomach, liver and kidney

Differentiation:

Constipation due to heat accumulation
Constipation due to qi stagnation
Constipation due to yin and blood xu
Constipation due to qi and yang xu

Therapeutics:

Moistening the intestines

Acupuncture:

Hegu	LI 4
Quchi	LI 11
Fujie	Sp 14
Shangjuxi	St 37
DaChangshu	UB 25

Herbal Formulation:

Moistening the intestines formula

Ma Zi Ren Wan

Ma Zi Ren (Cannabis seed)	30 g
Bai Shao (White peony)	15 g
Xing Ren (Apricot seed)	9 g
Zhi Shi (Immature bitter orange)	9 g
Da Huang (Rhubarb)	9 g
Hou Po (Magnolia Bark)	9 g